

TidyTuesday Week 39

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Monday 21st September, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

This week was a real barn-burner, if by "barn-burner" you mean we ran the regression machine exactly once and then presumably went to lie down. On the docket for September 21st: the Producer Price Index for Commercial Electric Power Distribution in New England, valiantly paired with a Medical Services Price Index for "Symptoms, Signs, and Ill-Defined Conditions." Yes, that is a real category. Yes, I too find it soothing that somewhere in the federal statistical apparatus there is an official price index for feeling vaguely unwell.

And oh, what a raw regression it was. R-squared of 0.93. A p-value with so many zeros after the decimal point it looks like a typo. If you squinted at nothing but this table, you'd walk away convinced that the cost of powering New England businesses is basically dictated by how much it costs to treat undiagnosable ailments – a bold theory that would revolutionize both cardiology and the electric grid. Someone alert the Nobel committee. Hold their calls, actually.

Then, as it so often does, the detrended regression walked into the room and turned on the lights. Strip out the fact that both of these numbers have simply drifted upward for decades like everything else in a modern economy, and the mighty 0.93 collapses to a heartbreaking 0.02, with a p-value of 0.51 – which in technical terms means "we have learned absolutely nothing." The relationship wasn't a relationship at all; it was two lines going up together because that's what prices do. A textbook trend mirage, and honestly a beautiful one. I got emotionally invested and everything.

As always, the fine print: these series are paired at random, there is no theory here, and no one should be reorganizing their portfolio around the deep spiritual bond between New England kilowatts and ill-defined medical conditions. Spurious is the house style, not the exception. Tune in next week, when we will once again mistake gravity for insight and act deeply surprised about it.

2 Date: 2026-09-21

Series ID: PCU221122221122421

This series is titled Producer Price Index by Industry: Electric Power Distribution: Commercial Electric Power for New England Census Division and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1990=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1971-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: SYSIILPIBLEND

This series is titled Medical Services Expenditures by Disease: Symptoms; Signs; and Ill-Defined Conditions Price Index, Blended Account Basis and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2017=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2021-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SYSIILPIBLEND	R-squared:	0.933
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.929
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	277.7
Date:	Mon, 21 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.41e-13
Time:	17:16:08	Log-Likelihood:	-68.300
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	140.6
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	142.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-6.0876	5.281	-1.153	0.263	-17.103	4.928
value_fred_PCU221122221122421	0.5458	0.033	16.664	0.000	0.477	0.614

Omnibus:	6.881	Durbin-Watson:	1.268
Prob(Omnibus):	0.032	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.911
Skew:	0.534	Prob(JB):	0.0521
Kurtosis:	5.304	Cond. No.	706.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

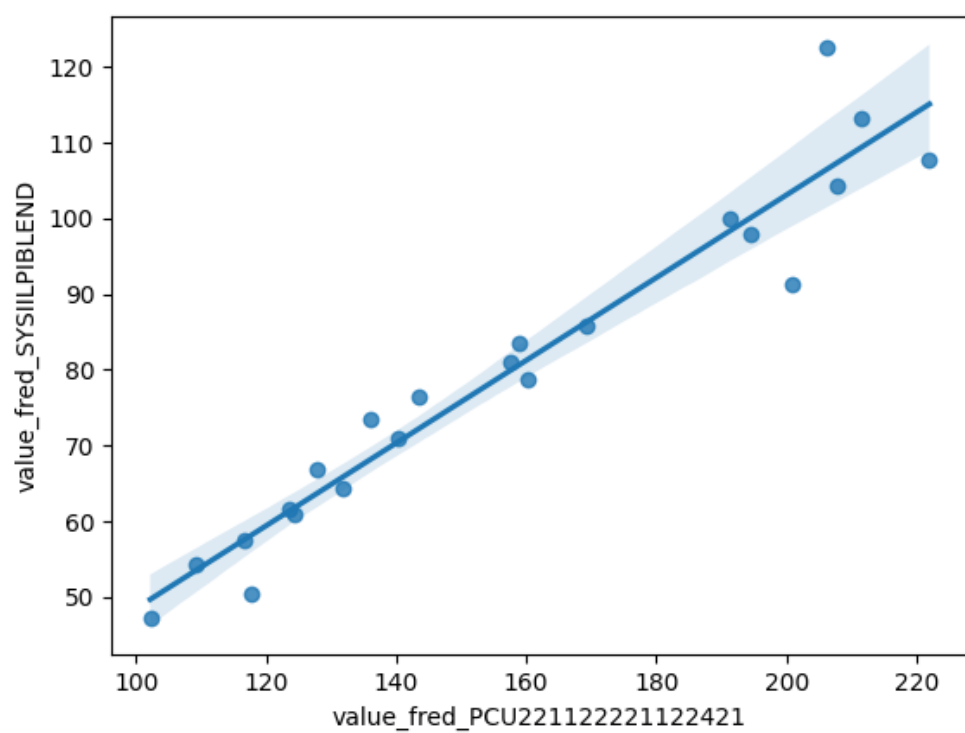


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-21

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SYSIILPIBLEND_detrended	R-squared:	0.022
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.027
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.4428
Date:	Mon, 21 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.513
Time:	17:16:08	Log-Likelihood:	-54.441
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	112.9
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	115.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.119e-14	0.643	6.41e-14	1.000	-1.340	1.340
value_fred_PCU221122221122421_detrended	0.0480	0.072	0.665	0.513	-0.103	0.199

Omnibus:	12.738	Durbin-Watson:	0.457
Prob(Omnibus):	0.002	Jarque-Bera (JB):	12.678
Skew:	1.200	Prob(JB):	0.00177
Kurtosis:	5.841	Cond. No.	8.90

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

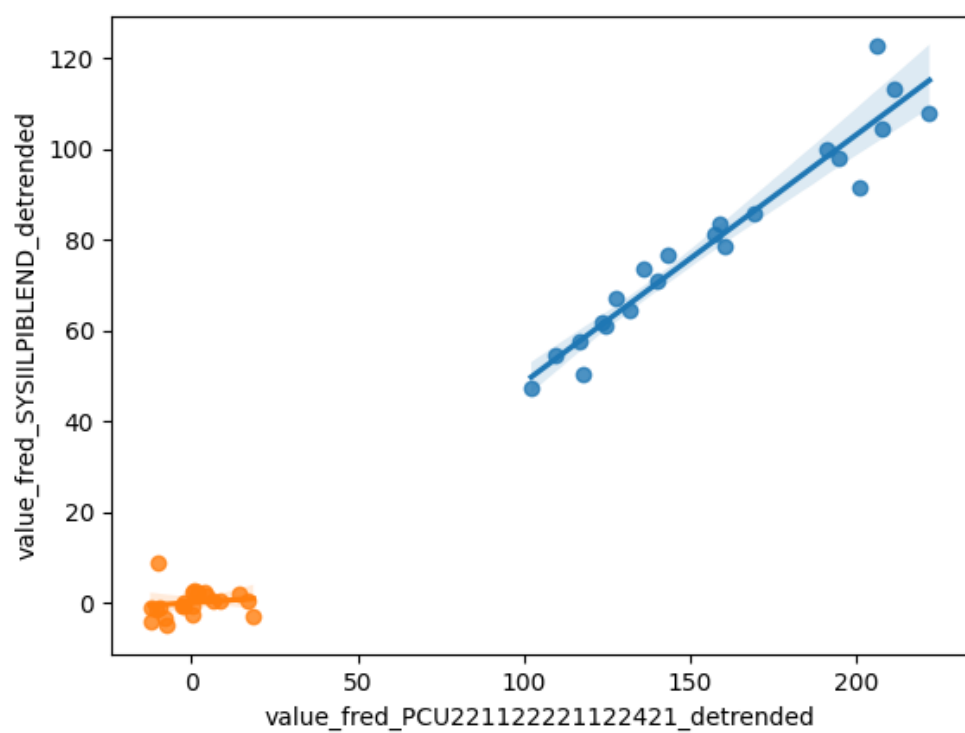


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-21